

English Competencies and Competency Levels by Grade

Every competency level for Grades 6 to 11 in one place, for lesson plans, term plans and SBA tools.

Where these come from

The competencies and competency levels below are taken from the **NIE English Language Teachers' Guides** for each grade. Each grade keeps its own guide's numbering and wording, because the guides do not always number the same level in the same way. Always check against the Teachers' Guide your school is using.

Not included yet: the primary grades, Grades 12 and 13 (A/L General English) and English Literature, because we do not have those Teachers' Guides. The **new 2026 Grade 6 syllabus** uses a different set of competencies; the Grade 6 table here follows the earlier syllabus.

The eight competencies (Grades 6 to 11)

Competency	Description
Competency 1	Identifies the sounds of English Language
Competency 2	Uses mechanics of writing with understanding
Competency 3	Engages in active listening and responds appropriately
Competency 4	Builds up vocabulary using words appropriately and accurately to convey precise meaning
Competency 5	Extracts necessary information from various types of texts
Competency 6	Uses English grammar for the purpose of accurate and effective communication
Competency 7	Uses English creatively and innovatively in written communication
Competency 8	Communicates clearly, fluently and concisely

Grade 6 competency levels

Source: Grade 6 Teachers' Guide (edition implemented from 2015). 47 competency levels.

This is the Grade 6 syllabus that the 2014 to 2019 Pupil's Book follows. The new 2026 Grade 6 syllabus uses a different set of competencies; schools following it should use the new Teachers' Guide.

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 1	1.1	Pronounces English words properly
Competency 1	1.2	Reads aloud different types of texts accurately and meaningfully
Competency 2	2.1	Uses capital and simple letters appropriately
Competency 2	2.2	Uses full stop appropriately
Competency 2	2.3	Uses question mark appropriately
Competency 3	3.1	Responds to simple announcements
Competency 3	3.2	Listens and follows instructions and responds to requests
Competency 3	3.3	Listens to a simple text for specific information
Competency 4	4.1	Uses masculine and feminine forms of nouns appropriately
Competency 4	4.2	Uses terms referring to young ones of animals appropriately
Competency 4	4.3	Finds synonyms and antonyms for given words
Competency 4	4.4	Uses affixes to change the word class and the meaning of words
Competency 4	4.5	Forms the plurals of nouns
Competency 5	5.1	Uses visual clues to derive the meaning of the text
Competency 5	5.2	Extracts specific information from various types of simple texts
Competency 5	5.3	Transfers information into other forms
Competency 5	5.4	Reads and responds to simple poems
Competency 5	5.5	Reads and understands simple folk stories
Competency 5	5.6	Extracts the general idea of a text
Competency 6	6.1	Constructs simple sentences
Competency 6	6.2	Uses pronouns appropriately
Competency 6	6.3	Uses modals meaningfully
Competency 6	6.4	Uses determiners
Competency 6	6.5	Uses contracted form
Competency 6	6.6	Uses adjectives
Competency 6	6.7	Uses prepositions appropriately
Competency 6	6.8	Uses conjunctions
Competency 6	6.9	Uses adverbs appropriately
Competency 7	7.1	Writes descriptions of people, animals, places and things
Competency 7	7.2	Describes pictures
Competency 7	7.3	Writes for personal purposes

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 7	7.4	Writes instructions
Competency 7	7.5	Writes simple compositions on different types of topics
Competency 7	7.6	Writes poems and stories
Competency 8	8.1	Introduces oneself to others
Competency 8	8.2	Uses simple expressions in greeting, thanking, affirming, denying
Competency 8	8.3	Describes objects, animals, people using simple sentence patterns
Competency 8	8.4	Speaks on familiar topics
Competency 8	8.5	Describes things in the immediate surrounding using adjectives
Competency 8	8.6	Uses simple structures to show ability and possession
Competency 8	8.7	Asks and gets personal information from others
Competency 8	8.8	Describes the position of things
Competency 8	8.9	Describes pictures
Competency 8	8.10	Speaks about daily actions
Competency 8	8.11	Describes past events and actions
Competency 8	8.12	Uses question words to get information
Competency 8	8.13	Uses language in variety of contexts

Grade 7 competency levels

Source: Grade 7 Teachers' Guide. The competency levels are listed as the guide presents them.

The Grade 7 guide lists 8.18 with the same wording as 8.13. It is shown here as printed.

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 1	1.1	Pronounces English words properly
Competency 1	1.2	Reads aloud different types of texts accurately and meaningfully
Competency 2	2.4	Uses apostrophe appropriately
Competency 3	3.3	Listens and responds to different types of simple texts
Competency 4	4.3	Finds synonyms and antonyms for given words
Competency 4	4.4	Uses affixes to change the word class and the meaning of words
Competency 4	4.5	Forms the plurals of nouns
Competency 4	4.6	Identifies collective nouns and compound nouns
Competency 5	5.1	Uses visual clues to derive the meaning of the text
Competency 5	5.2	Extracts specific information from various types of simple texts
Competency 5	5.3	Transfers information into other forms
Competency 5	5.4	Reads and responds to simple poems
Competency 5	5.5	Reads and understands simple folk stories
Competency 5	5.6	Extracts the general idea of a text
Competency 6	6.1	Constructs simple sentences
Competency 6	6.2	Uses pronouns appropriately
Competency 6	6.3	Uses modals meaningfully
Competency 6	6.4	Uses determiners appropriately
Competency 6	6.5	Uses contracted form
Competency 6	6.6	Uses adjectives appropriately
Competency 6	6.7	Uses prepositions appropriately
Competency 6	6.8	Uses conjunctions appropriately
Competency 6	6.9	Uses adverbs appropriately
Competency 7	7.1	Writes descriptions of people, animals, places and things
Competency 7	7.2	Describes pictures
Competency 7	7.3	Writes for personal purposes
Competency 7	7.4	Writes instructions
Competency 7	7.5	Writes simple compositions on different types of topics
Competency 7	7.6	Writes poems and stories
Competency 8	8.3	Describes objects, animals, people using simple sentence patterns
Competency 8	8.4	Speaks on familiar topics
Competency 8	8.6	Uses modals can, would, must and should

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 8	8.8	Describes the position of things
Competency 8	8.9	Describes pictures
Competency 8	8.13	Uses language in variety of contexts
Competency 8	8.17	Describes continuing actions
Competency 8	8.18	Uses language in variety of contexts

Grade 8 competency levels

Source: Grade 8 Teachers' Guide. 36 competency levels.

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 1	1.1	Pronounces English words properly
Competency 1	1.2	Reads aloud different types of texts accurately and meaningfully
Competency 2	2.5	Uses inverted commas appropriately
Competency 3	3.2	Listens and follows instructions and responds to requests
Competency 3	3.3	Listens and responds to different types of simple texts
Competency 3	3.4	Listens and transfers information to other forms
Competency 4	4.3	Finds synonyms and antonyms for given words
Competency 4	4.4	Uses affixes to change the word class and the meaning of words
Competency 4	4.5	Forms the plurals of nouns
Competency 4	4.7	Uses collective nouns and compound nouns
Competency 5	5.1	Uses visual and contextual clues to derive the meaning of the text
Competency 5	5.2	Extracts specific information from various types of simple texts
Competency 5	5.3	Transfers information into other forms
Competency 5	5.4	Reads and responds to simple poems
Competency 5	5.5	Reads and responds to simple folk stories / stories
Competency 5	5.6	Extracts the general idea of a text
Competency 6	6.1	Constructs simple sentences
Competency 6	6.2	Uses pronouns appropriately
Competency 6	6.3	Uses modals meaningfully
Competency 6	6.5	Uses contracted forms
Competency 6	6.6	Uses adjectives appropriately
Competency 6	6.7	Uses prepositions appropriately
Competency 6	6.8	Uses conjunctions appropriately
Competency 6	6.9	Uses adverbs appropriately
Competency 7	7.1	Writes descriptions of things, places and people
Competency 7	7.2	Describes pictures
Competency 7	7.3	Writes for personal purposes
Competency 7	7.4	Writes instructions
Competency 7	7.5	Writes simple compositions on different types of topics
Competency 7	7.6	Writes poems and stories
Competency 8	8.3	Describes objects, animals, people using simple sentence patterns
Competency 8	8.4	Speaks on familiar topics
Competency 8	8.6	Uses modals must, should, have to

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 8	8.8	Describes the position
Competency 8	8.9	Describes pictures
Competency 8	8.13	Uses language in a variety of contexts

Grade 9 competency levels

Source: Grade 9 Teachers' Guide. 45 competency levels.

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 1	1.1	Pronounces English words properly
Competency 1	1.2	Reads aloud different types of texts accurately and meaningfully
Competency 1	1.3	Pronounces English words and phrases properly
Competency 2	2.6	Uses commas with understanding
Competency 3	3.3	Listens to a simple text for specific information
Competency 3	3.4	Listens and transfers information to other forms
Competency 3	3.5	Identifies different intonation patterns and uses of word stress
Competency 4	4.3	Finds synonyms and antonyms for given words
Competency 4	4.4	Uses affixes to change the word class and the meaning of words
Competency 4	4.5	Forms the plurals of nouns
Competency 4	4.7	Uses nouns, verbs, adjectives and adverbs appropriately
Competency 4	4.8	Uses collective nouns and compound nouns properly
Competency 5	5.1	Uses visual clues to derive the meaning of texts
Competency 5	5.2	Extracts specific information from various types of simple texts
Competency 5	5.3	Transfers information into other forms
Competency 5	5.4	Reads and responds to simple poems
Competency 5	5.5	Reads and responds to simple folk tales
Competency 5	5.6	Extracts the general idea of a text
Competency 5	5.7	Infers ellipted information
Competency 5	5.8	Infers implied information
Competency 5	5.9	Recognizes the organization of a text
Competency 6	6.1	Constructs simple sentences
Competency 6	6.2	Uses pronouns appropriately
Competency 6	6.6	Uses adjectives properly
Competency 6	6.7	Uses prepositions appropriately
Competency 6	6.8	Uses conjunctions appropriately
Competency 6	6.9	Uses adverbs appropriately
Competency 6	6.10	Uses the conditional clauses appropriately
Competency 6	6.11	Uses reported speech accurately
Competency 7	7.1	Writes descriptions of people, animals, places and things
Competency 7	7.2	Describes pictures
Competency 7	7.3	Writes for personal purposes
Competency 7	7.4	Writes instructions

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 7	7.5	Writes simple compositions on different types of topics
Competency 7	7.6	Writes poems and stories
Competency 7	7.7	Writes for official purposes
Competency 8	8.3	Describes people, animals and objects using simple sentence patterns
Competency 8	8.4	Speaks on familiar topics
Competency 8	8.8	Describes the position of things accurately
Competency 8	8.9	Describes pictures
Competency 8	8.11	Describes past events and actions properly
Competency 8	8.12	Uses question words to get information
Competency 8	8.13	Uses language in a variety of contexts
Competency 8	8.14	Describes future events
Competency 8	8.15	Engages in telephone conversations

Grade 10 competency levels

Source: Grade 10 Teachers' Guide. 49 competency levels.

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 1	1.2	Reads aloud different types of texts accurately and meaningfully
Competency 1	1.4	Pronounces English words with different spellings
Competency 1	1.5	Pronounces English sentences properly
Competency 2	2.7	Uses exclamation mark appropriately
Competency 3	3.3	Listens to a simple text for specific information
Competency 3	3.4	Listens to and transfers information to other forms
Competency 3	3.5	Identifies different intonation patterns and uses of word stress
Competency 3	3.6	Listens to and reports information
Competency 3	3.7	Recognizes discourse markers
Competency 3	3.8	Takes notes from oral presentations
Competency 4	4.3	Finds synonyms and antonyms for given words
Competency 4	4.4	Uses affixes to change the word class and the meaning of words
Competency 4	4.5	Forms the plurals of nouns
Competency 4	4.7	Uses nouns, verbs, adjectives and adverbs appropriately
Competency 4	4.8	Uses collective nouns and compound nouns
Competency 5	5.1	Uses visual and contextual clues to derive the meaning of the text
Competency 5	5.2	Extracts specific information from various types of simple texts
Competency 5	5.3	Transfers information into other forms
Competency 5	5.4	Reads and responds to simple poems
Competency 5	5.5	Reads and responds to simple folk stories
Competency 5	5.6	Extracts the general idea of a text
Competency 5	5.7	Infers ellipted information
Competency 5	5.8	Infers implied information
Competency 5	5.9	Recognizes the organization of a text
Competency 6	6.1	Constructs simple sentences
Competency 6	6.2	Uses pronouns appropriately
Competency 6	6.3	Uses modals meaningfully
Competency 6	6.6	Uses adjectives appropriately
Competency 6	6.7	Uses prepositions appropriately
Competency 6	6.8	Uses conjunctions appropriately
Competency 6	6.9	Uses adverbs appropriately
Competency 6	6.10	Identifies 'If' type 3
Competency 6	6.11	Uses reported speech

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 7	7.1	Writes descriptions of people, animals, places and things
Competency 7	7.2	Describes pictures
Competency 7	7.3	Writes for personal purposes
Competency 7	7.4	Writes instructions
Competency 7	7.6	Writes poems and stories
Competency 7	7.7	Writes for official purposes
Competency 7	7.9	Writes compositions
Competency 8	8.3	Describes objects, animals and people using simple sentence patterns
Competency 8	8.4	Speaks on familiar topics
Competency 8	8.9	Describes pictures
Competency 8	8.11	Describes past events and actions
Competency 8	8.12	Uses question words to get information
Competency 8	8.13	Uses language in a variety of contexts
Competency 8	8.14	Describes future events and actions
Competency 8	8.15	Engages in telephone conversations
Competency 8	8.16	Engages in debates

Grade 11 competency levels

Source: Grade 11 Teachers' Guide. The guide introduces no new competency levels for Grade 11: it brings together the levels of Grades 6 to 10 so that students can master them before the O/L examination.

The Grade 11 guide numbers some levels differently from the Grade 10 guide (for example, Writes compositions is 7.9 in Grade 10 and 7.8 here; Engages in debates is 8.16 in Grade 10 and 8.18 here). The Grade 11 numbering is shown as printed.

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 1	1.1	Pronounces English words properly
Competency 1	1.2	Reads aloud different types of texts accurately and meaningfully
Competency 1	1.3	Pronounces English words and phrases properly
Competency 1	1.4	Pronounces English words with different spellings properly
Competency 2	2.1	Uses capital and simple letters appropriately
Competency 2	2.2	Uses full stop appropriately
Competency 2	2.3	Uses question mark appropriately
Competency 2	2.4	Uses apostrophes appropriately
Competency 2	2.5	Uses inverted commas appropriately
Competency 2	2.6	Uses commas with understanding
Competency 2	2.7	Uses exclamation mark appropriately
Competency 3	3.1	Responds to simple announcements
Competency 3	3.2	Listens and follows instructions
Competency 3	3.3	Listens and responds to different types of simple texts
Competency 3	3.4	Listens and transfers information to other forms
Competency 3	3.5	Identifies different intonation patterns and uses of word stress
Competency 3	3.6	Listens and reports information
Competency 3	3.7	Recognizes discourse markers
Competency 3	3.8	Takes notes from oral presentations
Competency 4	4.1	Uses masculine and feminine forms of nouns appropriately
Competency 4	4.2	Uses terms referring to young ones of animals appropriately
Competency 4	4.3	Finds synonyms and antonyms for given words
Competency 4	4.4	Uses affixes to change the word class and the meaning of words
Competency 4	4.5	Forms the plurals of nouns
Competency 4	4.6	Identifies collective nouns and compound nouns
Competency 4	4.7	Uses nouns, verbs, adjectives and adverbs appropriately
Competency 4	4.8	Uses collective nouns and compound nouns properly
Competency 5	5.1	Uses visual clues to derive the meaning of texts
Competency 5	5.2	Extracts specific information from various types of simple texts
Competency 5	5.3	Transfers information into other forms
Competency 5	5.4	Reads and responds to simple poems

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 5	5.5	Reads and understands simple folk tales
Competency 5	5.6	Extracts the general idea of a text
Competency 5	5.7	Infers implied information
Competency 5	5.8	Recognizes the organization of a text
Competency 6	6.1	Constructs simple sentences
Competency 6	6.2	Uses pronouns appropriately
Competency 6	6.3	Uses modals meaningfully
Competency 6	6.4	Uses determiners properly
Competency 6	6.5	Uses the contracted forms
Competency 6	6.6	Uses adjectives properly
Competency 6	6.7	Uses prepositions appropriately
Competency 6	6.8	Uses conjunctions appropriately
Competency 6	6.9	Uses adverbs appropriately
Competency 6	6.10	Uses the conditional clauses appropriately
Competency 6	6.11	Uses reported speech accurately
Competency 7	7.1	Writes descriptions of people, animals, places and things
Competency 7	7.2	Describes pictures
Competency 7	7.3	Writes for personal purposes
Competency 7	7.4	Writes instructions
Competency 7	7.5	Writes simple compositions on different types of topics
Competency 7	7.6	Writes poems and stories
Competency 7	7.7	Writes for official purposes
Competency 7	7.8	Writes compositions
Competency 8	8.1	Introduces self
Competency 8	8.2	Uses simple expressions appropriately in greeting, thanking, affirming, denying
Competency 8	8.3	Describes people, animals, and objects using simple sentence patterns
Competency 8	8.4	Speaks on familiar topics
Competency 8	8.5	Describes things in the immediate surrounding using adjectives
Competency 8	8.6	Uses simple structures to show ability and possibility
Competency 8	8.7	Asks and gets personal information from others
Competency 8	8.8	Describes the position of things
Competency 8	8.9	Describes pictures
Competency 8	8.10	Speaks about daily actions
Competency 8	8.11	Describes past events and actions properly
Competency 8	8.12	Uses question words to get information

Competency	Level	Competency level
Competency 8	8.13	Uses language in a variety of contexts
Competency 8	8.14	Describes continuing actions
Competency 8	8.15	Uses perfect tense appropriately
Competency 8	8.16	Describes future events and actions appropriately
Competency 8	8.17	Engages in telephone conversations
Competency 8	8.18	Engages in debates

Complete lesson plan books are coming

These are simple sample plans. **Complete lesson plan books for every grade** will be part of **RCF Premium Resources**, which will be ready in the future. [See RCF Premium Resources](#)

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